PROJECT 2

Client Portal with Automated Onboarding

Requirements & Acceptance Criteria

Document Version	1.0
Date	April 2026
Prepared For	Resource A (GHL Specialist) & Resource B (WordPress/React Specialist)
Prerequisite	Project 1 (Lead Capture & CRM Pipeline) completed
Estimated Duration	14–18 Working Days

1. Project Overview

Build a React-based client portal where customers of a fictional digital marketing agency, "NovaPulse Digital," can log in, view their project status, upload documents, and track milestones. The backend onboarding process is fully automated through Go High Level workflows and n8n/Make, ensuring zero manual effort from signup to first task assignment.

1.1 Business Scenario

NovaPulse Digital signs 5–10 new clients per month. Each new client goes through the same onboarding process: welcome email, intake questionnaire, document collection, project kickoff meeting, and task assignment. Currently this is done manually over email. The portal automates the entire flow and gives clients a self-service dashboard.

1.2 Objectives

- Demonstrate React frontend development with authentication, state management, and file handling
- Showcase GHL workflow automation for multi-step onboarding sequences
- Prove n8n/Make proficiency with complex, multi-trigger automation chains
- Cross-train: Resource B teaches A React fundamentals; Resource A teaches B GHL workflow builder logic

1.3 Skills Progression from Project 1

This project increases complexity over Project 1 in the following ways:

- Frontend moves from WordPress (template-based) to React (component-based with state)
- GHL workflows become multi-step with conditional branching and stage-dependent triggers
- Automations involve bidirectional data flow (portal ↔ GHL ↔ notifications) instead of one-directional
- File uploads and document management introduce new integration patterns

2. Roles & Responsibilities

Area	Resource A (GHL Specialist)	Resource B (WP/React Specialist)
Primary Build	GHL onboarding workflows, pipeline, email/SMS sequences, internal task assignment automation	React client portal (auth, dashboard, project tracker, document upload, onboarding wizard)
Automation	Co-build n8n/Make workflows (GHL webhook triggers, pipeline stage events, task creation)	Co-build n8n/Make workflows (user signup events, file upload triggers, API integrations)
Cross-Training	Learn from Resource B: React component structure, props/state, hooks (useState, useEffect), API calls with fetch/axios	Learn from Resource A: GHL workflow builder, conditional logic, triggers vs actions, multi-step automations
QA & Review	Test portal login flow, file uploads, and verify data reaches GHL correctly	Test GHL workflows fire correctly, verify emails/SMS content, check pipeline transitions

3. Detailed Requirements

3.1 React Client Portal

Owner: Resource B (with guidance to Resource A)

3.1.1 Authentication System

- Registration page with fields: Full Name, Email, Password, Company Name, Phone Number
- Login page with email/password authentication
- Password strength validation (minimum 8 characters, 1 uppercase, 1 number, 1 special character)
- "Forgot Password" flow with email reset link (simulated or via a service like Firebase Auth / Supabase Auth)
- Persistent sessions using JWT tokens stored in httpOnly cookies or secure local state

- Protected routes: unauthenticated users are redirected to the login page
- Logout button clears session and redirects to login

3.1.2 Client Dashboard

After login, the client sees a dashboard with the following sections:

A) Welcome Banner

- Personalized greeting: "Welcome back, [Company Name]"
- Onboarding progress bar showing completion percentage (e.g., 2 of 5 steps done)
- Quick action buttons: "Upload Documents," "Book Kickoff Call," "View Project Status"

B) Project Status Cards

- Each active project displayed as a card with: Project Name, Current Phase (e.g., "Strategy," "Design," "Development," "Review"), Start Date, Next Milestone, and a colored status badge (On Track / At Risk / Delayed)
- Clicking a card opens a detailed project view (see 3.1.3)

C) Recent Activity Feed

- Chronological list of the last 10 events: document uploads, status changes, messages, meetings booked
- Each entry shows: timestamp, event type icon, description

D) Quick Links Sidebar

- Links to: My Documents, Support/Help, Book a Meeting (GHL calendar link), Account Settings

3.1.3 Project Detail View

- Horizontal milestone timeline showing all project phases with current phase highlighted
- Phase details section: description of current work, expected deliverables, due date
- File exchange area: client can upload files and see files shared by the agency (mockup with local/cloud storage)
- Comments/Notes section: threaded conversation between client and agency (can be simulated with local state or a simple backend)

3.1.4 Onboarding Wizard

A guided, multi-step onboarding flow that appears for new users who have not completed onboarding:

1. Step 1 — Company Profile: Company website URL, industry (dropdown), team size (dropdown: 1–5, 6–20, 21–50, 50+), brief description of business
2. Step 2 — Service Selection: Checkboxes for services needed (SEO, PPC, Social Media, Web Design, Branding, Content Marketing)
3. Step 3 — Document Upload: Upload area for brand guidelines, logos, existing marketing materials (accepts PDF, PNG, JPG, DOCX; max 10MB per file, max 5 files)
4. Step 4 — Goals & Timeline: Text area for project goals, dropdown for preferred timeline (1 month, 3 months, 6 months, ongoing), budget range dropdown ($1K–$3K, $3K–$5K, $5K–$10K, $10K+)

5. Step 5 — Book Kickoff Call: Embed or link to GHL calendar booking page for a 45-minute kickoff call

Each step must be completable independently (user can save progress and return later). A progress indicator must show which steps are complete, current, and pending.

3.1.5 Document Management

- "My Documents" page listing all uploaded files in a table: File Name, Type, Size, Upload Date, Status (Received / Under Review / Approved)
- Upload functionality with drag-and-drop zone and file browser fallback
- File type validation: accept only PDF, PNG, JPG, JPEG, DOCX, XLSX (show error for disallowed types)
- File size validation: reject files over 10MB with a clear error message
- Download functionality for agency-shared files
- Delete option for files uploaded by the client (with confirmation dialog)

3.1.6 UI/UX Requirements

- Clean, modern design with consistent color scheme and typography (use Tailwind CSS or a component library like Shadcn/UI)
- Fully responsive: desktop (1200px+), tablet (768px–1199px), mobile (below 768px)
- Loading states with skeleton screens or spinners for all async operations
- Toast notifications for success/error events (e.g., "File uploaded successfully," "Login failed")
- Accessible: proper labels on form fields, keyboard-navigable, sufficient color contrast
- Empty states: meaningful illustrations or messages when no projects, documents, or activity exist

Acceptance Criteria — Section 3.1

#	Acceptance Criteria	Owner
1	User can register, log in, and log out; sessions persist on page refresh until explicitly logged out	Resource B
2	Protected routes redirect unauthenticated users to login; direct URL access to /dashboard without auth redirects to /login	Resource B
3	Onboarding wizard saves progress per step; user can exit and resume from the last completed step	Resource B
4	File upload accepts only allowed types (PDF, PNG, JPG, DOCX, XLSX) and rejects files over 10MB with clear inline error	Resource B
5	Dashboard displays project cards with correct status badges; clicking opens the detail view with milestone timeline	Resource B
6	All pages render correctly on 375px (mobile), 768px (tablet), and 1200px+ (desktop) without horizontal scroll or broken layouts	Resource B

7	New user signup fires a webhook POST to n8n/Make with user profile data (name, email, company, phone) within 5 seconds	Both
8	Onboarding wizard completion (all 5 steps) fires a separate webhook with aggregated onboarding data	Both
9	Document upload triggers a webhook with file metadata (name, type, size, user ID) for each uploaded file	Both

3.2 Go High Level CRM & Onboarding Automation

Owner: Resource A (with guidance to Resource B)

3.2.1 Pipeline Configuration

Create a pipeline named "NovaPulse Client Onboarding" with the following stages:

1. New Signup — Client has registered on the portal but not started onboarding
2. Profile Completed — Client has filled out company profile (Step 1 of wizard)
3. Services Selected — Client has chosen desired services (Step 2)
4. Documents Uploaded — Client has submitted required files (Step 3)
5. Goals Defined — Client has set goals and timeline (Step 4)
6. Kickoff Scheduled — Client has booked the kickoff call (Step 5)
7. Onboarding Complete — All steps done; project is active
8. Stalled — Client has not progressed for 7+ days

3.2.2 Contact & Custom Fields

- Company Name (text)
- Company Website (URL)
- Industry (dropdown matching wizard)
- Team Size (dropdown matching wizard)
- Services Requested (multi-select: SEO, PPC, Social Media, Web Design, Branding, Content Marketing)
- Budget Range (dropdown matching wizard)
- Timeline Preference (dropdown matching wizard)
- Onboarding Progress (number: 0–5, representing completed steps)
- Lead Source (auto-tagged: "Client Portal")

3.2.3 Automation Workflows (Inside GHL)

Workflow 1: Welcome & Onboarding Start

- Trigger: New contact created in "New Signup" stage
- Action 1: Send welcome email (immediate) — personalized with company name, login link, onboarding checklist overview

- Action 2: Send welcome SMS (within 2 minutes) — short intro + link to portal
- Action 3: Internal notification — Slack/email to account manager with new signup details
- Action 4: Wait 48 hours → If still in "New Signup" stage, send reminder email: "You haven't started onboarding yet"

Workflow 2: Step-by-Step Progress Nudges

- Trigger: Contact remains in any stage (Profile Completed through Goals Defined) for more than 3 days
- Action 1: Send a contextual nudge email specific to the next step (e.g., if in "Services Selected" stage, nudge to upload documents)
- Action 2: Wait 2 more days → Send SMS nudge
- Action 3: Wait 2 more days (total 7 days stalled) → Move to "Stalled" stage and notify account manager

Workflow 3: Kickoff Call Confirmation

- Trigger: Appointment booked via GHL calendar (kickoff call)
- Action 1: Move contact to "Kickoff Scheduled" stage
- Action 2: Send confirmation email with meeting details (date, time, video call link placeholder)
- Action 3: Send reminder email 24 hours before
- Action 4: Send reminder SMS 1 hour before

Workflow 4: Onboarding Complete

- Trigger: Contact moved to "Onboarding Complete" stage
- Action 1: Send congratulations email with next steps and assigned account manager details
- Action 2: Send internal email to the project team with full client profile, selected services, uploaded documents, and goals
- Action 3: Create a task in GHL (or via n8n) assigned to the account manager: "Prepare project kickoff brief for [Company Name]"

Workflow 5: Re-engagement for Stalled Clients

- Trigger: Contact enters "Stalled" stage
- Action 1: Wait 1 day → Send a personal-tone email from the account manager: "Noticed you haven't finished setting up — can we help?"
- Action 2: Wait 3 days → Send a final SMS: "Your portal is waiting — pick up where you left off"
- Action 3: Wait 7 more days → If still stalled, tag as "Needs Manual Follow-Up" and alert the account manager

3.2.4 Calendar Setup

- Calendar name: "Client Kickoff Call"
- Duration: 45 minutes
- Availability: Mon–Fri, 10:00 AM – 4:00 PM
- Buffer time: 15 minutes before and after

- Max bookings per day: 3
- Booking page embeddable or linkable from the React portal (Step 5 of wizard)

3.2.5 Email & SMS Templates

All templates must include:

- Merge fields: {{contact.first_name}}, {{contact.company_name}}, {{custom.onboarding_progress}}
- Professional design with NovaPulse branding (logo placeholder, consistent colors)
- Clear CTAs with buttons linking back to the portal or calendar
- Unsubscribe footer for emails
- Total templates required: 12 emails + 8 SMS messages across all workflows

Acceptance Criteria — Section 3.2

#	Acceptance Criteria	Owner
1	Pipeline has all 8 stages; contacts transition between stages correctly via automation and manual move	Resource A
2	Welcome sequence fires within 2 minutes of new contact creation with personalized content	Resource A
3	Step-progress nudge emails reference the correct next step based on the contact's current stage	Resource A
4	Stalled contacts are auto-moved after 7 days of inactivity and account manager is notified	Resource A
5	Kickoff calendar enforces 3 bookings/day max and 15-minute buffer; booking link works from the portal	Resource A
6	Onboarding complete workflow sends the full client brief internally with all custom field data populated	Resource A
7	All 12 email and 8 SMS templates render correctly with merge fields and have functional CTA links	Resource A
8	Re-engagement workflow escalates stalled clients through 3 touch-points over 11 days before tagging for manual follow-up	Resource A

3.3 Automation Workflows (n8n / Make)

Owner: Both Resources (collaborative build)

3.3.1 Workflow 1: User Signup → GHL Contact Creation

1. React portal sends a webhook POST on new user registration
2. n8n/Make receives the payload: name, email, phone, company name
3. Validate that email is properly formatted and all required fields are present
4. Create a new contact in GHL via API with all fields mapped

5. Place contact in "New Signup" pipeline stage
6. Tag contact with "Client Portal" as lead source
7. If contact already exists (duplicate email), update the existing record and log a "Returning Signup" event
8. Send an internal Slack notification: "New client signup: [Company Name] — [Email]"

3.3.2 Workflow 2: Onboarding Step Completion → GHL Pipeline Update

1. React portal sends a webhook on each onboarding step completion with: user ID/email, step number (1–5), step data
2. n8n/Make maps the step number to the corresponding GHL pipeline stage
3. Move the contact to the corresponding stage via GHL API
4. Update the "Onboarding Progress" custom field with the step number
5. If step = 5 (all steps complete), move to the "Onboarding Complete" stage
6. Log each step completion to a Google Sheet (columns: Timestamp, Company, Email, Step Number, Step Name, Data Summary)

3.3.3 Workflow 3: Document Upload → Notification & Logging

1. React portal sends a webhook on each file upload with: user email, file name, file type, file size, upload timestamp
2. n8n/Make validates file metadata (type is allowed, size is within limit)
3. Log the upload to a Google Sheet tab "Document Log" (columns: Timestamp, Client Email, Company, File Name, Type, Size, Status)
4. Send a Slack notification to the assigned account manager: "[Company Name] uploaded [File Name]"
5. If the upload is part of onboarding Step 3 and is the first file, trigger a GHL tag: "Documents Received"

3.3.4 Workflow 4: Daily Onboarding Summary Report

1. Scheduled trigger: runs daily at 9:00 AM
2. Query the Google Sheet for all onboarding events from the previous 24 hours
3. Compile a summary: total new signups, step completions by step, stalled clients, completed onboardings
4. Send the summary via email (or Slack) to the agency operations manager

3.3.5 Workflow 5: Error Handling & Retry Logic

1. If any GHL API call fails, retry once after 60 seconds
2. If retry fails, log the error to a Google Sheet tab "Error Log" with: Timestamp, Workflow Name, Error Message, Full Payload
3. Send an alert email to the technical lead with the error details
4. For webhook validation failures (missing fields), respond with a 400 status and log the event without retrying

Acceptance Criteria — Section 3.3

#	Acceptance Criteria	Owner
1	New user signup on the React portal creates a GHL contact in the correct pipeline stage within 30 seconds	Both
2	Each onboarding step completion moves the GHL contact to the correct stage; verified by completing all 5 steps in sequence	Both
3	Duplicate signups update the existing contact and log a "Returning Signup" event without creating a second record	Both
4	Document upload triggers Slack notification with correct file details within 1 minute	Both
5	Google Sheet "Document Log" tab contains accurate entries for every uploaded file	Both
6	Daily summary email is sent at 9:00 AM with accurate counts matching the Google Sheet data	Both
7	API failures trigger retry once, then log to Error Log tab with full payload; alert email is sent to the technical lead	Both
8	All 5 workflows can be demonstrated end-to-end in a single screen recording for portfolio use	Both

4. Cross-Training Deliverables

By the end of this project, each resource must demonstrate increased competency from Project 1.

Resource A Must Demonstrate	Resource B Must Demonstrate
• Can explain the React component tree of the portal (parent/child relationships) • Can modify a React component's props or state to change displayed data • Can write a simple useEffect hook that fetches data from an API endpoint • Can add a new field to the onboarding wizard form and connect it to the webhook payload • Can run the React app locally using npm start and debug a basic console error	• Can build a 3-stage GHL pipeline from scratch with contact custom fields • Can create a 4-step GHL automation workflow with wait timers and conditional IF/ELSE branching • Can set up a GHL calendar with availability rules and embed/link it externally • Can configure a GHL webhook (outbound) that triggers on a pipeline stage change • Can troubleshoot a failed GHL workflow by reading the execution log

5. Technology Stack

Component	Technology
Frontend	React 18+ with Vite or Next.js (App Router)
Styling	Tailwind CSS + Shadcn/UI component library
Authentication	Firebase Auth, Supabase Auth, or Clerk (free tier)
File Storage	Firebase Storage, Supabase Storage, or Cloudinary (free tier)
Backend (optional)	Supabase (Postgres + REST API) or Firebase Firestore for user data
CRM	Go High Level (sub-account)
Automation	n8n (self-hosted or cloud) OR Make.com
Notifications	Slack (webhook) + Email (SMTP/Gmail)
Data Logging	Google Sheets API
Hosting	Vercel or Netlify (React frontend)

6. Suggested Timeline

Days	Task	Owner
1–2	Environment setup: React project scaffold (Vite/Next.js), auth provider config, GHL sub-account, n8n/Make workspace, Google Sheet templates	Both
3–5	React: Auth system (register, login, logout, protected routes), basic layout/navigation shell	Resource B
3–5	GHL: Pipeline with 8 stages, all custom fields, email/SMS templates (first 6 of 12 emails, 4 of 8 SMS)	Resource A
6–8	React: Dashboard (project cards, activity feed, sidebar), project detail view with milestone timeline	Resource B
6–8	GHL: All 5 automation workflows built and tested independently, remaining templates, calendar setup	Resource A
9–11	React: Onboarding wizard (5 steps with save/resume), document management page with upload/download/delete	Resource B

9–11	n8n/Make: Build Workflows 1–3 (signup → GHL, step completion → pipeline, document upload → notification)	Both
12–13	n8n/Make: Workflows 4–5 (daily summary report, error handling). Connect all webhooks end-to-end	Both
14–15	Integration testing: full onboarding journey (signup → all 5 steps → GHL pipeline → notifications → Google Sheet). Edge case testing (duplicates, stalled clients, file validation errors)	Both
16	Cross-training sessions: Resource A demos React skills, Resource B demos GHL skills (per Section 4)	Both
17–18	Portfolio packaging: screen recordings, Loom walkthroughs, deploy portal to Vercel/Netlify, case study writeup	Both

7. Portfolio Deliverables

Upon completion, the following assets should be ready for Upwork profile use:

- Live deployed React client portal on Vercel/Netlify (with demo credentials for walkthrough)
- GitHub repository with clean commit history, README with setup instructions, and architecture diagram
- GHL pipeline and workflow screenshots showing all 8 stages, 5 workflows, and sample contact journeys
- A 5–7 minute Loom video demonstrating: new user signup → onboarding wizard (all 5 steps) → GHL pipeline progression → automated emails/SMS → document upload → Google Sheet logging → daily summary
- n8n/Make workflow exports (JSON) with documentation explaining each workflow's purpose and triggers
- A written case study (400–600 words) covering: client problem, solution architecture, tools used, automation flow diagram, and measurable outcomes (e.g., "onboarding time reduced from 5 days manual to same-day automated")
- Google Sheet with sample data across all tabs (Onboarding Log, Document Log, Error Log) demonstrating the logging system

8. Definition of Done

This project is considered complete when ALL of the following are true:

- All acceptance criteria from Sections 3.1, 3.2, and 3.3 are met and independently verified

- A complete end-to-end test has been recorded on video covering the full onboarding journey from signup to "Onboarding Complete" in GHL
- The React portal is deployed and accessible via a public URL with demo login credentials
- Both resources have completed their cross-training demonstrations (Section 4) with evidence
- All portfolio deliverables listed in Section 7 are packaged, reviewed, and ready for Upwork profiles
- No known bugs, broken workflows, or unhandled error states remain
- Code is committed to a Git repository with a README that enables a third party to run the project locally